**EXPERIMENT-14**

**Exploring Pro-Code Extension of a Zoho Creator Application Using Zoho Catalyst / Custom Functions**

## Aim:

To explore the extension of a Zoho Creator Insurance Claim application using pro-code techniques such as Deluge custom functions and Zoho Catalyst, enabling advanced business logic, external service integration, and improved application functionality.

## Overview:

Low-code platforms such as Zoho Creator allow applications to be developed using visual tools, predefined forms, reports, and workflows. However, complex enterprise applications may require additional programming capabilities to implement advanced business logic, integrate external services, and perform specialized processing.

Pro-code extension refers to enhancing a low-code application by writing custom code or connecting it to external backend services. Zoho Creator supports Deluge scripting and custom functions to perform operations that go beyond basic form configuration. Zoho Catalyst is a cloud development platform that can be used to build backend services, APIs, and serverless functions.

In the Insurance Claim application, pro-code techniques can be used to validate claim amounts, calculate remaining policy coverage, automate claim processing, and connect the application with external systems. For example, a custom function can calculate the remaining coverage of an insurance policy, while a Catalyst backend service could support more complex processing or external integrations.

This experiment explores how custom functions and external backend services can extend the capabilities of a Zoho Creator application.

## Procedure:

### Step 1: Open the Zoho Creator Application

Log in to Zoho Creator and open the existing **Insurance Claim** application. Review the Customer Details, Insurance Policy, and Insurance Claim forms to understand the application structure.

### Step 2: Identify the Requirement

Identify a task that requires advanced business logic, such as calculating the remaining policy coverage, validating claim amounts, or processing claim information.

**Step 3: Create a Deluge Custom Function**

Navigate to the Functions or Custom Functions section in Zoho Creator. Create a function to retrieve the policy details, calculate the total approved claim amount, and determine the remaining coverage. Handle null values and invalid inputs appropriately.

**Step 4: Integrate the Function with a Workflow**

Open the Insurance Claim form workflow and configure it to call the custom function when required. Use the returned value to support claim validation and prevent claims from exceeding the available coverage.

**Step 5: Test the Custom Function**

Submit a valid claim and verify the result. Then test a claim that exceeds the remaining policy coverage and confirm that the configured validation behaves correctly.

**Step 6: Explore Zoho Catalyst**

Open the Zoho Catalyst website and explore its backend development features, including serverless functions and API endpoints. Identify how these features could support advanced insurance claim processing.

**Step 7: Explore External Service Integration**

Study how Zoho Creator can communicate with an external Catalyst service through APIs and Deluge integration tasks such as `invokeurl`. Review the required authentication, request data, response handling, and error management.

**Step 8: Verify and Document**

Verify that the existing application continues to work correctly. Record the custom function's purpose, the Catalyst features explored, and the observed test results.

## Result:

Thus, the pro-code extension of the Zoho Creator Insurance Claim application was explored using Deluge custom functions and Zoho Catalyst. The procedure demonstrated how custom code and external backend services can extend application functionality, support advanced business logic, and enable integration with external systems.